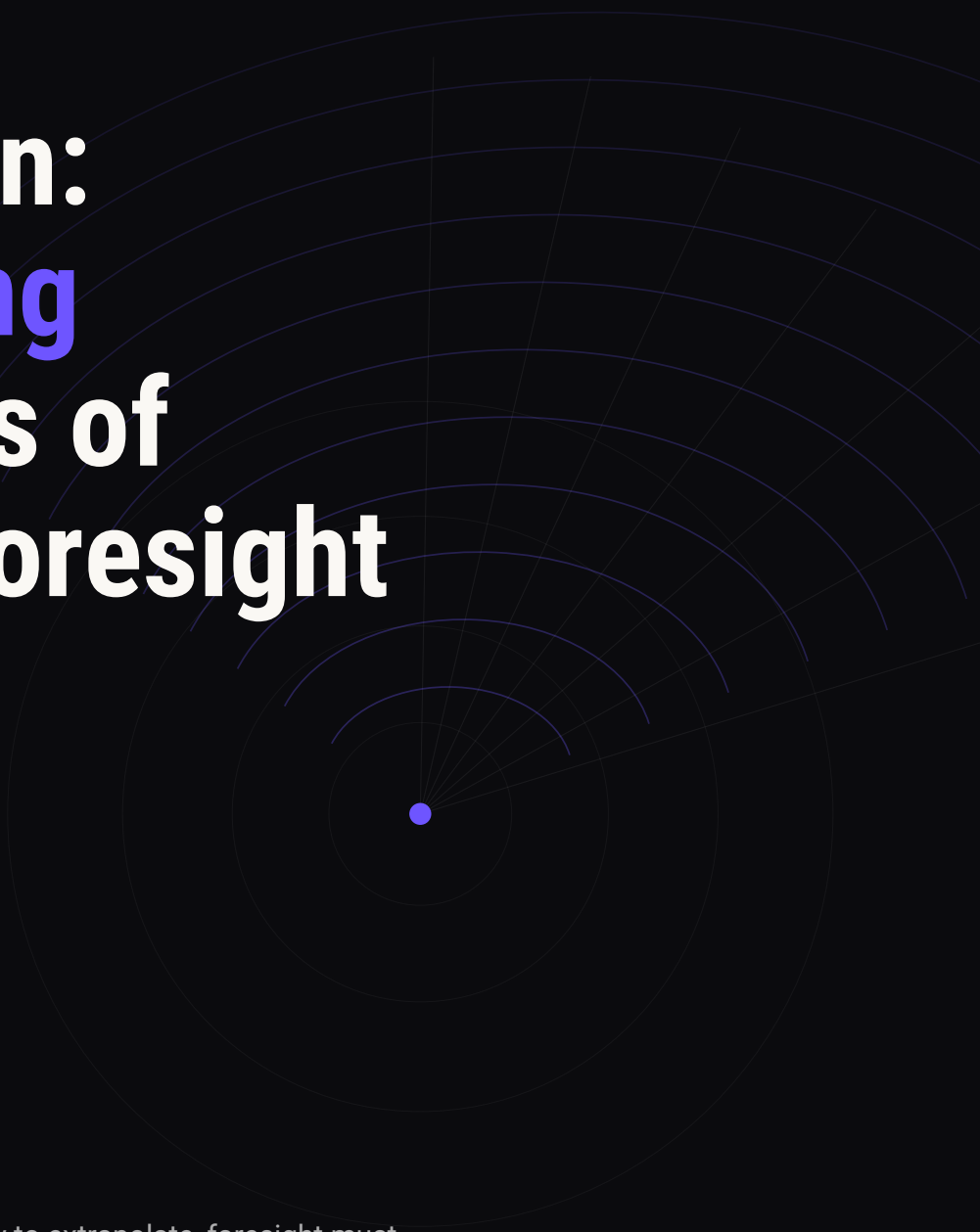


Beyond Prediction: Navigating the Limits of Human Foresight



When the future exceeds our ability to extrapolate, foresight must become a practice of epistemic humility.



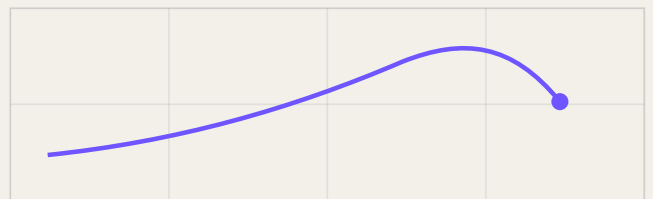
The future is not a trend line.

What happens when the future is no longer something we can rationally compute?

We live in an age where the impossible becomes routine. AI generates poetry, simulates scientific discoveries, and outmaneuvers humans in games once thought to require intuition and genius. Yet, for all our advances, we are limited - not by technology, but by imagination itself.

Our traditional foresight models - predictions based on past trends, incremental progress, and extrapolation - assume that the future will resemble the present, just slightly enhanced. But what if it doesn't?

PAST DATA / PRESENT MODEL / PROJECTION



EXTRAPOLATION BREAKS HERE

Science fiction has long served as an imaginative playground for these ideas, yet even the boldest speculative visions are shaped by contemporary assumptions. Could AI begin to generate futures beyond human comprehension, constructing possibilities so far removed from our current epistemological grounding that they escape our ability to engage with them? If so, what does that mean for governance, ethics, and strategy?

THE CENTRAL LIMIT

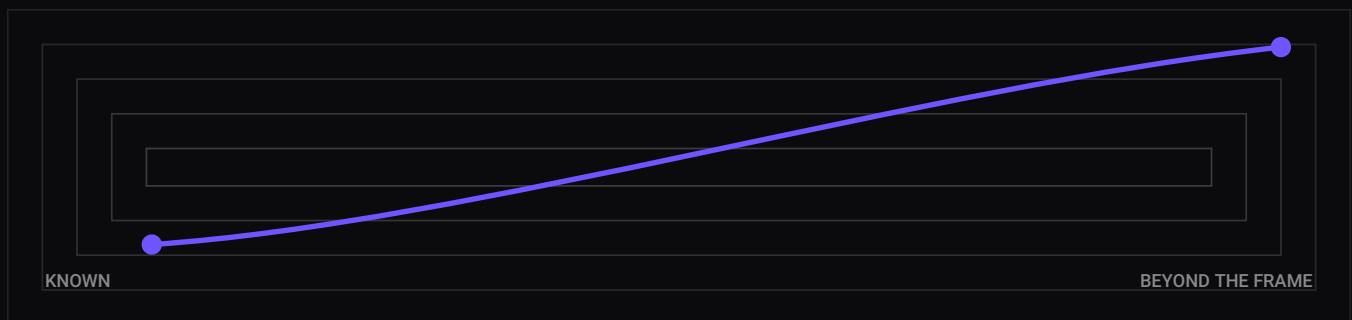
What if the most disruptive shifts are not just hard to predict, but fundamentally unthinkable within our current cognitive and conceptual frameworks?

Imagination has a frame.

Human cognition evolved for survival, not for infinite abstraction. Neuroscience suggests our brains filter complexity to maintain coherence; we resist the unknowable because it destabilizes our reality. But what if the very survival skill that has guided our progress now limits our ability to see what comes next? Are we, as a species, nearing a threshold where our foresight is no longer sufficient to navigate what we create?

The rise of AI, synthetic biology, quantum computing, and other disruptive fields hints at trajectories that could diverge from human-centered expectations. If technology accelerates beyond our ability to model it, how do we prepare for futures that refuse to be forecasted? Should we rethink our entire approach to scenario planning, moving from prediction to radical epistemic humility? And if so, what does that look like in practice?

COGNITIVE FRAME



FROM PREDICTION TO EPISTEMIC HUMILITY

These are not questions with easy answers. But they are questions we must ask - before the unthinkable arrives, and we are left staring at a future we can no longer grasp.